

Pramaan Relay

A life certificate should not die between systems.

A process-first civic-tech prototype that turns the gap between a generated Digital Life Certificate and pension-agency acceptance into a traceable, retryable, accountable handoff.

THE PRODUCT DECISION

Build. A generated life certificate becomes an accountable handoff that the pension agency—not the pensioner—must finish. After a T+1 breach, the prototype can request one guarded, non-renewable seven-day administrative hold while the agency decides. The hold is proposed policy, not current law or a payment guarantee.

8.9 / 10

collision-adjusted concept score

4 journeys

working adversarial scenarios

0 real IDs

synthetic, self-contained build

ROUND 1 DEADLINE

**28 August 2026
8:00 PM IST**

DELIVERABLES IN THIS PACK

Product decision · evidence · collisions · state machine · prototype ·
free-tool/AI-search plan · video script · test report

Independent hackathon prototype. Not affiliated with MeitY, NIC, Jeevan Pramaan, EPFO, any bank, pension authority, or the Government of India.

01 · PRODUCT THESIS

Change the responsibility boundary, not the screen

FIRST-PRINCIPLES INSIGHT

The citizen has already completed the hard action: biometric proof. If the downstream handoff is late, asking the pensioner to regenerate converts an agency/system failure into fresh citizen non-compliance. Pramaan Relay makes that transfer of responsibility explicit.

The documented seam

- Successful authentication generates a DLC and Pramaan ID.
- The certificate becomes electronically available to the PDA.
- PDA acceptance remains a separate authority decision.
- The citizen is expected to discover accepted/rejected status.

What the product changes

- 01 Seal one stable handoff receipt and payload hash.
- 02 Retry delivery idempotently; never create a duplicate case.
- 03 Require an explicit agency fetch acknowledgement.
- 04 Return acceptance or a field-scoped rejection reason.
- 05 Route one recovery case without erasing the original proof.

Customer job

“After I prove I am alive, tell me who has my certificate, what they did with it, and what happens while they fix a delay.”

T+1

DoPPW record-update / message direction

19,268

rejections in one bank's Campaign 4.0

42 days

one current unresolved self-report

Evidence limits

The 19,268 figure is 24.1% of 79,905 uploads for Central Bank of India's Campaign 4.0 only—not a national rate. The 42-day report is one high-intensity current signal, not prevalence evidence. The structural handoff claim rests on official process sources.

02 · RESEARCH REGISTER

Evidence before features

Claims, provenance, confidence, and the limit that prevents overstatement.

Claim	Source	Confidence	Bounded reading
Generation ≠ acceptance	Official Jeevan Pramaan FAQ	High	DLC becomes available to the PDA but remains subject to authority approval.
Status should return	NIC/Jeevan Pramaan process flow	High	Published diagram shows DLC pushed to PDA and status pushed back.
T+1 update / SMS	DoPPW O.M., 13 Jan 2025	High text / medium-high hosting	Signed document found on a third-party mirror; stable official file URL did not surface.
Reasons and daily processing	DoPPW O.M., 20 Feb 2024	High text / medium-high hosting	Requires daily processing, same-day messages, explicit rejection reasons and wrong-PDA handling.
Material rejection causes	35th SCOVA minutes, 4 May 2026	High	One bank/campaign: 79,905 uploaded, 60,637 updated, 19,268 rejected; wrong accounts/PDA cited.
Receipt accountability	RBI circulars, 2015 and 2021	High	Acknowledgements/system receipts are encouraged; misplaced certificates had deprived regular payments.
Current user signal	Reddit EPFO report, 23 Aug 2026	Medium existence / low prevalence	Generated DLC reportedly absent after 42 days during migration/maintenance.

POLICY BOUNDARY

No standing, cross-PDA seven-day protection was found. CONTINUITY_HOLD is a proposal. A real pilot needs government decisions on scheme differences, fraud controls, recovery, liability, and whether only automated suspension—or payment itself—is affected.

Why the official evidence matters

The novelty is not another reminder or status page. Existing rules already expect processing, messages, acknowledgements, and reasons. The product operationalizes the missing chain of custody: who received the exact payload, when responsibility moved, what decision was returned, and how the original proof survives recovery.

03 · NOVELTY TEST

The idea tournament and public collision scan

Concept	Score	Decision	Collision-adjusted rationale
Pramaan Relay	8.9	WIN	Documented system seam; dramatic state-machine demo; lowest screened direct collision.
Nagrik Relay / EPFO repair	8.5	Reject	Strong repair graph, but several current builds already cover blockers, preflight and correction.
RC Handover Lock	6.4	Reject	Direct cooperative ownership-transfer build plus commercial seller-protection overlap.
Seva Savepoint	5.8	Reject	Novel intent receipt, but too cross-service and cannot protect statutory deadlines without authority.
RTI obligation ledger	5.2	Reject	Same-hackathon builds already classify answers, track deadlines and generate appeals.

Visible public-build collisions screened

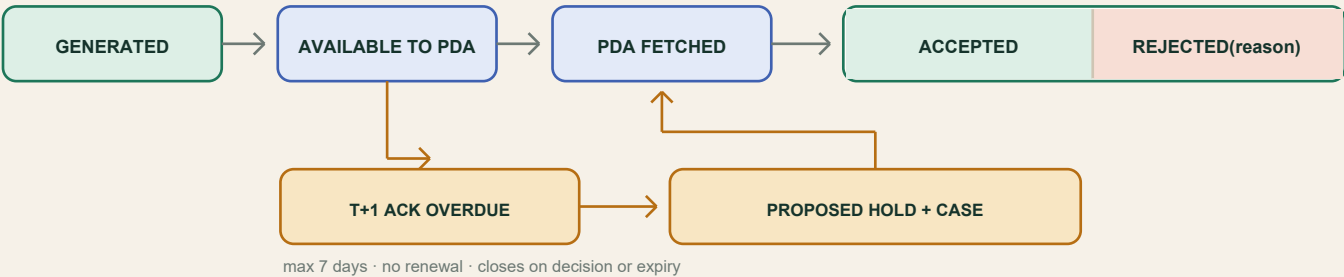
Build	Overlap	Design consequence
Jeevan Pramaan Reimagined	Same named service; public README describes a web-first entry/routing shell.	Differentiate on outbox, fetch acknowledgement, reasons and hold.
CivicFlow	Generic civic AI; pension/life certificate appears as one scenario.	Avoid chatbot and generic routing language.
EPFO Claim Clarity	Preflight, blocker visibility and same-claim repair.	Killed EPFO repair concept.
ch0sa/vahan	End-to-end cooperative vehicle transfer.	Killed ordinary RC-transfer concept.
RTIReimagine / RightsTrack	RTI analysis, status/deadline and appeals.	Killed RTI lane.

HONEST NOVELTY CLAIM

No direct public build found in the 27 August searches implemented the complete T+1 watchdog + stable handoff identity + fetch receipt + reason-coded recovery + guarded seven-day hold. Private and unindexed submissions remain unknowable.

04 · PRODUCT SPECIFICATION

The interface is not the product. The state contract is.



Non-negotiable invariants

- 01
- GENERATED never equals ACCEPTED.
- 02
- Only a PDA event can accept or reject.
- 03
- Every rejection carries a reason code.
- 04
- One certificate/PDA pair has one active relay.
- 05
- Retries reuse a stable idempotency key.
- 06
- A corrected payload links to original evidence.

Atomic receipt

- receipt ID and correlation ID
- masked certificate reference and payload hash
- generation and scheme-deadline timestamps
- expected T+1 target and handoff age
- agency owner, attempts and acknowledgement
- reason code, hold basis/expiry and closing event

AI boundary

An OpenAI model may turn an unstructured remark into a candidate reason code and plain English/Hindi explanation. A deterministic validator and human/agency response confirm it. AI never changes transaction, deadline, eligibility or payment state.

Pilot architecture

ADAPTER → EVENT STORE → TRANSACTIONAL OUTBOX → PDA ADAPTER → ACKNOWLEDGEMENT INBOX

The citizen status API reads a deterministic reducer over append-only events. Signatures, persistence, notifications, identity checks and real government adapters are mocked in Round 1; the in-browser reducer and evidence model are working.

05 · THE OUT-OF-BOX BET

A seven-day hold that cannot become an endless loophole

The memorable mechanism is also the highest-risk one. The simulation permits the hold only when all eight conditions pass; it creates an escalation at the same instant and always closes with a receipt.

- 01

A verifiable Jeevan Pramaan generation event exists.
- 02

Generation occurred before the scheme-specific deadline.
- 03

The pension was active immediately before that deadline.
- 04

The selected PDA/PSA is onboarded or a deterministic correct route is known.
- 05

No death, duplicate, fraud or contradictory-life-event flag exists.
- 06

The hold lasts at most seven days and cannot renew itself.
- 07

A PDA/nodal escalation is created at the same moment.
- 08

Acceptance, reasoned rejection or expiry closes it with a receipt.

168 h

maximum simulated hold

1×

non-renewable by design

3 exits

accept · reject · expire

What the prototype says

SAFE WORDING

“This prototype requests a one-time seven-day administrative hold while a timely DLC is processed. It is not current law or a payment guarantee.”

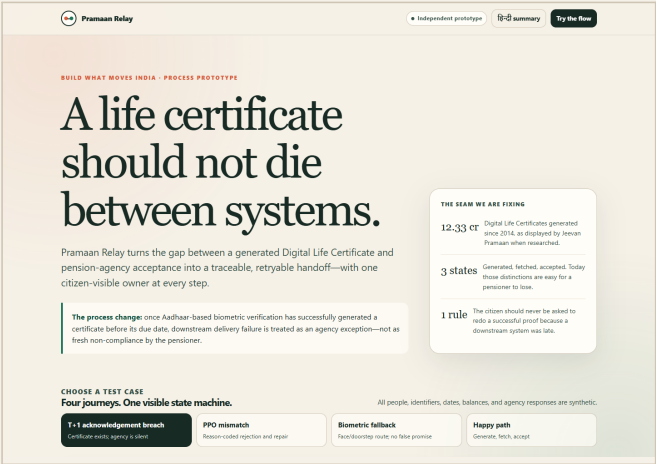
What it never says

FORBIDDEN CLAIM

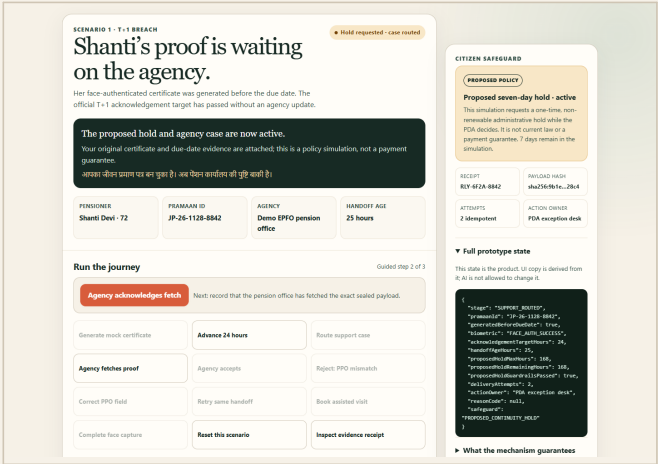
Never: “Your pension is legally protected,” “generation means acceptance,” or “AI approved this case.” If the demo loses this distinction, kill the feature rather than soften the disclaimer.

06 · WORKING PROTOTYPE

Four adversarial journeys, one visible reducer



Answer-first hero and scenario selector



Hold active: owner, receipt, remaining time and reducer state

Scenario	Working transition	Why it matters
T+1 breach	Request hold + route → fetch → accept	Proves accountability transfer and policy boundary.
PPO mismatch	Reject(reason) → correct one field → same relay → accept	Proves least-destructive recovery.
Biometric fallback	No certificate → assisted face route → generate → decide	Proves the product never invents submission.
Happy path	Generate → fetch → accept	Proves ordinary success also earns a receipt.

Round 1 implementation

Single self-contained HTML file; pure JavaScript reducer; no login, API key, database, cookies or persistence. JSON-LD, FAQ, evidence register, llms.txt, pricing page and robots.txt are included. Upload the prototype folder to any static host.

07 · DISTRIBUTION

Free by design; discoverable by evidence, not content volume

24 / 25

useful · immediate · simple · shareable · adjacent

₹0

no signup, paywall or lead form

1 metric

completed understanding

Free-tool strategy

- No identity-gated conversion in a civic-benefit prototype.
- Desired action: understand generated vs accepted.
- Then inspect/download the synthetic evidence packet.
- Share the process proposal with a policy or engineering reviewer.

Privacy rules

- No real Aadhaar, PPO, bank, OTP or biometric input.
- No cookies, advertising, retargeting or local persistence.

AI-search foundations shipped

- Answer-first canonical product definition.
- Semantic headings and source-backed FAQ.
- WebApplication + FAQPage JSON-LD.
- Dated evidence register with confidence limits.
- llms.txt, pricing.md and robots.txt.

Queries worth answering

Jeevan Pramaan generated but not accepted · DLC pending with pension agency · difference between generated and accepted life certificate · PPO mismatch rejection

NORTH-STAR METRIC

Percentage of first-time testers who can correctly say, after one minute: "Generated and agency accepted are different states." Search traffic is secondary; understanding is the outcome.

AI role in the hackathon build

Codex was used across official-source research, Firecrawl-assisted discovery, candidate generation, public collision scanning, adversarial state design, implementation, automated interaction tests and this submission pack. Runtime generative AI is deliberately optional because the public-service transaction must remain deterministic.

Paste-ready 241-word summary

Pramaan Relay fixes one invisible break in India’s Digital Life Certificate journey: a certificate can be successfully generated in Jeevan Pramaan yet still wait for the Pension Disbursing Agency to fetch and accept it.

DoPPW directs PDAs to update records and send acceptance/rejection SMS on T+1. Yet official minutes and a current user report show wrong routing, rejections, and delayed updates can still return the burden to an elderly pensioner. Pramaan Relay changes the process, not the interface.

After successful biometric generation, it seals a synthetic handoff receipt with a stable ID, timestamp, payload hash, receiving agency, and due-date evidence. Delivery retries are idempotent, so an outage cannot create duplicate cases. The states remain explicit: Generated, Available to Agency, Agency Fetched, Accepted, or Rejected with a reason code. A stale handoff automatically creates one evidence-backed agency case instead of restarting the citizen.

The prototype also demonstrates a deliberately labelled policy proposal: after a T+1 breach, an eligible, on-time certificate can request one non-renewable seven-day administrative hold while an agency case is resolved. Eight synthetic safety guardrails govern eligibility and acceptance, reasoned rejection, or expiry closes the hold. This is not current law or a payment guarantee.

Everything is synthetic. No Aadhaar, PPO, bank, OTP, face image, biometric, or government API is used. The reducer, retry rules, event trail, four adversarial scenarios, and downloadable evidence packet work entirely in the browser. Codex supported research, collision analysis, state-machine design, implementation, and testing.

Real, mocked, proposed

Layer	Status
Reducer, transitions, ageing, expiry, receipt	Working in browser
Pensioner, IDs, biometric, agency decisions	Synthetic
Jeevan Pramaan / PDA / SMS adapters	Mocked
T+1 update and message target	Official direction represented; enforcement mocked
One-time seven-day administrative hold	Proposed policy; not law or payment guarantee

09 · DEMO PLAN

Two minutes: citizen first, architecture second

Time	What to show / say
0:00–0:08	Introduce synthetic Shanti; DLC generated before due date.
0:08–0:18	Show T+1 breach. Say: generated is not accepted.
0:18–0:31	Point to stable receipt, hash, idempotent retry and proposed-hold eligibility.
0:31–0:43	Click Request hold + route. Explain one case + one non-renewable request.
0:43–0:53	Click Agency acknowledges fetch. Responsibility is now visible.
0:53–1:00	Click Accept and close. One proof, one relay, one audit trail.
1:00–1:15	PPO mismatch: reason → one-field repair → same history.
1:15–1:27	Biometric fallback: no generated proof means no hold claim.
1:27–1:43	Open reducer and receipt; AI cannot change transaction state.
1:43–2:00	State synthetic/proposed boundary; close with the tagline.

Deployment checklist

- Deploy prototype/ to a public static URL with no login.
- Retest on an Android-sized viewport and slow connection.
- Confirm all scenarios and JSON download on the public URL.
- Keep the independent-prototype disclaimer visible.
- Use no government emblem or affiliation-like branding.

Submission checklist

- Citizen journey occupies the first minute.
- Paste the 241-word summary unchanged.
- Say what is working, mocked and proposed.
- Use synthetic data only in the recording.
- Submit before 28 Aug 2026, 8:00 PM IST.

JUDGE ANSWER

Is this just a tracker? No. A tracker reads state. Pramaan Relay creates the operating contract: stable handoff identity, delivery semantics, receiver acknowledgement, reasoned decision, bounded safeguard and recovery receipt.

10 · VALIDATION AND HANDOFF

What passed, what remains, and where every claim came from

Area	Observed	Result
Primary path	Route → fetch → accept	Pass
Hold limit	168 hours → expiry; no renewal	Pass
Mismatch recovery	Reject → correct → resend → accept	Pass
Biometric fallback	No false certificate/hold claim	Pass
Evidence packet	Dialog + JSON parse/download	Pass
Structured data	Every JSON-LD block parses	Pass
Small viewport	320 px, no horizontal overflow	Pass
Runtime	No console/page errors	Pass

Research/build method

- Official brief and video inspected first.
- Firecrawl used for source extraction and collision discovery.
- Recent-signal search was treated as directional, not prevalence.
- Four agents independently attacked brief, pain, whitespace and novelty.
- Younix's audit-first workflow lens shaped receipts, owners, reasons and explicit evidence boundaries.

Still not verified

- Public deployment and public-URL performance.
- Real PDA/Jeevan Pramaan adapters or signatures.
- Policy legality, fraud, recovery and liability design.
- Production security/load and cross-screen-reader coverage.
- National prevalence; public collision scan cannot see private builds.

Primary and current sources

[Official builder brief](#) · [Briefing video](#) · [Jeevan Pramaan FAQ](#) · [NIC process flow](#)

[Signed DoPPW T+1 memorandum mirror](#) (third-party hosting caveat) · [35th SCOVA minutes](#) · [RBI 2021 master circular](#) · [RBI 2015 acknowledgement circular](#)

[Current 42-day EPFO report](#) (one self-report; not prevalence evidence)

FINAL RECOMMENDATION

Submit Pramaan Relay only if the demo remains a working process contract. If it turns into a status dashboard, chatbot, UI reskin or pension guarantee, the differentiator is gone.